Why your drains back up in a hurricane

1. **Slope.** Drain lines fall about 1/4 inch per foot so gravity carries water away.
2. **Trap.** The U-bend under each fixture holds water that blocks sewer gas. A dry floor drain smells: pour in a bucket of water.
3. **Vent.** The pipe through your roof lets air in so flushing doesn't siphon traps dry.
4. **Backwater valve.** A one-way flap on the main line that closes when the city sewer backs up. Have a licensed plumber install it; it needs maintenance.
5. **During a flood.** While the valve is closed, your own water can't leave. Go easy on sinks, washer and toilet.
6. **Check coverage.** Standard homeowner policies often exclude sewer backup and flood. Ask about a sewer-backup rider.

Go deeper: Survival Prep: Essential Skills

View on Amazon: https://www.amazon.com/dp/B0DK7MPQ2K

Sources:

FEMA: Protect your property from flooding - https://www.fema.gov/emergency-managers/risk-management/building-science